

Digital Life

Amongst the complicated tech around us, we tend to overlook the mundane.

**Windows Evolution**

Do you recollect how windows 1.0 used to look like? And the versions later? Check out the GIF and the mini website: <http://dgit.in/win1to10>

Existing technologies India needs NOW!

Enough of all the dreaming of the future and fantastic ways in which technology can help our country... here are a few that already exist, all we need is implementation

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"The future is already here — it's just not very evenly distributed", said Sci-Fi author, William Gibson in the 1990 documentary, 'Cyberpunk'.

In the documentary, he discusses the inequality in access to technological developments based on wealth and location. Countries such as Germany, China and Finland have been playing host to such developments for some time now, while India seems to be trailing behind despite being the world's largest sourcing destination for information technology (IT), an industry that reportedly employs more than 10 million Indians. Let's look at tech taken for granted elsewhere that could really help India.

1 City-wide free Wi-Fi

A sure sign of a progressive nation is the ability to quickly and easily access the Internet, anywhere and everywhere. South Korea shows us the way here – reportedly the most wired country in the world. In Seoul, you can, as a visitor to the city, log on to their free Wi-Fi and get speeds of about 47 Mbps. When you're in a new city, you're usually using a mapping service to get around, and this can result in a lot of data being consumed – at pro-



Free Wi-Fi is present everywhere in Korea

hibitive costs if you're roaming. Although cities such as Bangalore and Patna already have free Wi-Fi, more of this is needed, and across the country. Currently, you're capped to about 50 MB per day or 15 minutes in the day, after which you're expected to pay. Obviously that should be improved.

Internet service provider Ozone Networks, currently India's largest public Wi-Fi provider, is one of the facilitators of this service and has over 6,500 hotspots located across the country, including at Haldiram's, McDonald's outlets and the Mumbai International Airport. However, beyond the first 30 minutes you need to buy a data pack costing ₹ 30 and upwards.

Earlier this year, the Narendra Modi government allocated a budget of ₹ 7,000 crore under its 'Digital India' initiative to create around 50,000 to 60,000 Wi-Fi hotspots in 2,500 cities across India in partnership with state-run telecom firm, BSNL. We can hardly wait.

2 Babelfish

Say you're backpacking in Europe. All you have to do is whip out your smartphone, key in an input or say a phrase and resources like 'Google Translate' and 'Speak and Translate' return the result to you in the target language either in text form or as an electronic voice.